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Masood Azhar: The Principle of Consensus

The negotiation between India and China over the listing of Maulana Masood Azhar Alvi as a terrorist under the relevant provisions of the United Nations was among the longest drawn-out talks in bilateral relations. What was presumed to be an open-and-shut case began in March 2009 and which was expected to be concluded within the year, dragged on for a full decade.

Masood Azhar was born in Bahawalpur, Pakistan, and was drawn to radical Islam early on in his life. As an active member of the terrorist group Harkat-ul-Ansar, he had been apprehended in India in the early 1990s. He spent six years in custody before the Government of India exchanged him on 31 December 1999, in return for the more than 170 passengers and crew aboard the Indian airliner IC-814 that had been hijacked to Kandahar in Afghanistan by five Pakistan-based terrorists led by Masood Azhar's brother. Masood Azhar went on to establish the Jaish-e-Mohammed (The Army of Mohammed or JeM). JeM has been responsible for several deadly terrorist